

LOADZONE · CALCULATION NOTE

LoadZone sizing calculations

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First TRL 3 sizing note (airtime, energy and cell life, latency, link, detection, loads, size and mass, sign option, cost) with a status for every requirement

LoadZone sizing calculations

On paper, LoadZone meets nine of its fifteen requirements (five by calculation, four by design), has three at risk, misses two and leaves one that only an installation trial can settle. **R4 is not met:** from road level under a parked van, a puck reaches a gateway about 350 m away in a street canyon at SF9 with a 10 dB fade margin, not 1 km. **R11 is not met at night:** the e-paper sign reads at about 28 m by day, better than the TRL 2 estimate of 10 m, but it is unlit. R1 (detection), R5 (airtime at slow data rates) and R6 (bond under braking) are at risk. The core numbers of the TRL 2 concept stand or improve: cell life is 7.7 years at SF9, the worst-case report time is 38.6 s, and the two-puck kit costs \$114.00 against the \$120 budget.

Every number in this note is printed by `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`; the tag in brackets, for example [B2], is the line of the script's output that carries it. Run it from the repo root with `python docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`; it also writes `docs/04-calcs/results.csv`. The script imports `PARAMS`, `derived()` and the part volumes from `cad/src/model.py`, so the geometry here is the geometry in the STEP files and in drawing LDZ-DWG-001. It reads the costs from `bom/bom.csv` and `budget_usd` from `project.yaml`. All values are first-principles estimates; nothing is measured.

Safety: These are paper estimates. They do not show that a puck is safe to leave in a roadway, that the primary lithium cells are safe in a hot road, or that the bond will hold. Bond strength, cell temperature and crush behavior must be checked on hardware before any puck is installed, and only under a road permit with traffic management. See LDZ-PRC-001, Safety.

■ 1. Assumptions

Table 1. Inputs. All are assumptions for a paper design unless a source is given.

Input	Value	Basis
Traffic	100 state changes a day per puck plus hourly heartbeats: 124 uplinks	LDZ-REQ-001 R3
Payload	12 bytes plus 13 bytes of LoRaWAN overhead, 125 kHz, CR 4/5	LDZ-PRC-001
Radio currents	45 mA transmit at +14 dBm, 4.6 mA receive, 8 mA controller awake 0.5 s per uplink, two 0.1 s receive windows	Same as FND-CAL-001
Sleep and sampling	6 μ A sleep; one reading a second, 10 ms awake at 2 mA	LDZ-PRC-001 v0.2
Cells	2 x 2.6 Ah in parallel, derated 40 % for cold, pulse loads, self-discharge and end-of-life voltage	ER14505 class, typical rating
Fair use	30 s of uplink airtime and 10 downlinks per node per day on The Things Network	TTN, checked 2026-09-25
Duty cycle	1 % on the EU868 default sub-band; 10 % on the RX2 sub-band	EU868 regional rules
Link	Puck antenna -2 dBi once potted; 10 dB road-level loss; 10 dB (typical) to 20 dB (worst) for a van overhead; gateway 10 m high, 2 dBi, 2 dB feeder loss; 6 dB noise figure	Estimates; FND-CAL-001 for the gateway side
Path loss	3GPP TR 38.901 urban microcell street canyon (UMi), Table 7.4.1-1, at 868 MHz with the user height at its 1.5 m floor; the road-level loss covers the lower antenna	Standard model, used outside its height range
Detection	A vehicle is a line of vertical induced dipoles along its length; 10 μ T under the middle of a parked van (calibration); 3 μ T threshold, 10 times the magnetometer's 0.3 μ T RMS noise	Assumption; only a field log can set these
Loads	Half of a 10 t single axle (49 kN), x1.3 dynamic; friction 0.7; rigid cast polyurethane 40 MPa and semi-rigid potting 15 MPa in compression; adhesive-to-asphalt shear 1.0 MPa at 20 °C, 0.2 MPa at 50 °C	Typical values, to be checked against chosen materials
Vehicles	Bay 2.6 m wide; van 2.0 m wide, 1.75 m track, 225 mm tires; car 1.8 m, 1.55 m, 200 mm	Typical dimensions
Sign	Class C receiver on at 15.2 mW; 200 redraws a day at 26.4 mW for 5 s plus the controller; 90 % rail efficiency; 7.5 in panel with a 97.9 mm active height, digits 80 % of it	Typical 7.5 in panel data
Legibility	30 ft of distance per inch of letter height (0.36 m per mm)	MUTCD, section 2A.13

■ 2. Airtime (R5)

A 12-byte uplink is on air for 61.7 ms at SF7, 205.8 ms at SF9 and 1,482.8 ms at SF12 [A1]. At 124 uplinks a day that is 7.7 s at SF7, 14.0 s at SF8 and 25.5 s at SF9, all within the 30 s fair-use limit, but 51.0 s at SF10 and 183.9 s at SF12 [A1]. At SF10 even the state changes alone exceed the limit: 73 uplinks a day is the most that fits. **R5 is at risk:** met at SF7 to SF9, not met at SF10 and slower. The TRL 2 note used FieldNode's longer 20-byte airtime and gave 31 s at SF9; with the 12-byte payload SF9 fits with hourly heartbeats, so the 2 h heartbeat fallback is no longer needed at SF9. A private gateway (TwinKit) is bound only by the 1 % duty cycle, which allows far more.

■ 3. Energy and cell life (R3)

At SF9 a puck uses 1.11 mAh a day: 0.144 mAh asleep, 0.480 mAh for sampling (20 μ A average) and 0.488 mAh for 124 uplinks at 14.2 mA·s each [B1, B2]. That is 0.406 Ah a year against 3.12 Ah usable, **a life of 7.7 years, and R3 is met** [B2, B3]. Sampling and uplinks each take about 44 % of the budget [B3], so a slower sampling rate is the first lever if life must grow. Life is 9.6 years at SF7, 6.0 years at SF10 and 2.8 years at SF12 [B2], so pucks far from a gateway fail R3 as well as R5.

Pulse supply. One SF9 uplink draws 9.3 mC; if the capacitor supplied it alone with 0.3 V of droop it would need 31 mF, and 222 mF at SF12 [B4]. Bobbin Li-SOCl₂ cells cannot deliver 45 mA pulses well, so the capacitor is essential. Ordinary supercapacitors are often rated only to 60 to 70 °C, below the road-surface target, so the BOM now calls for an 85 °C hybrid pulse capacitor.

Supply voltage. Fresh Li-SOCl₂ cells sit at about 3.67 V open circuit, above the 3.6 V recommended maximum of STM32WL-class modules. One Schottky diode per cell brings this to 3.42 V and also stops one cell charging the other, which primary lithium cells must never do [B5]. This is an engineering proposal (LDZ-DDR-001, O6).

■ 4. Report latency (R2)

A new state must hold for 15 s, sampling adds up to 1 s and the network path about 2 s, so a report reaches the server in 17.7 s typically [C1]. The worst case adds the EU868 duty-cycle wait after the previous uplink: 20.4 s at SF9, for 38.6 s in all, and 59.2 s at SF10 [C1]. **R2 is met at SF10 or faster**; at SF11 (100.3 s) and SF12 (166.3 s) it is not.

■ 5. Link from road level (R4)

With 11.5 dBm EIRP the link budget at SF9 is 141.0 dB [D1, D2]. The UMi model gives 127.0 dB of non-line-of-sight path loss at 1 km to a 10 m gateway, and 118.4 dB in line of sight [D1]. Adding 10 dB for an antenna at road level and 10 dB for a van overhead leaves **-6.0 dB at 1 km out of sight and 2.6 dB in line of sight; with the worst vehicle loss, -16.0 dB** [D2]. The range out of sight is 678 m with no fade margin and 353 m with 10 dB [D2]. SF12 would reach 576 m with the fade margin [D2] but breaks R3 and R5. **R4 is not met.** The TRL 2 note said a gateway "a few hundred meters away" would work; that stands, and it is the proposed restatement of R4 (LDZ-DDR-001, O2). The UMi model is used below its 1.5 m height floor; the 10 dB road-level loss is the estimate that covers this and only a field survey can settle it.

■ 6. Detection (R1)

With the line-dipole model calibrated to 10 μ T under a parked van, a car gives 10.6 μ T, a small car pushed to one end of the 7 m slot 10.5 μ T, a high-chassis box truck 7.7 μ T and a box truck with little steel low down 3.85 μ T, just 1.28 times the 3 μ T threshold [E1]. A van passing in the next lane gives 0.46 μ T and a van parked in the next slot 0.08 μ T, both well below the threshold [E1]. The geometry therefore favors the slot-center position (D3): vehicles anywhere in the slot are seen, and neighbors are not. The margins rest on the 10 μ T calibration, which is an assumption. **R1 is at risk and not verifiable at TRL 3**; high-clearance trucks are the weak case, and a short field log under parked vehicles would settle it.

■ 7. Loads and bond (R6)

The load basis is now set: half of a 10 t single axle, 49.0 kN static, or 63.8 kN with a 1.3 dynamic factor for slow maneuvering [F1]. If the whole wheel bears on the 92 mm flat crown, the stress is 7.38 MPa static and 9.59 MPa dynamic; spread over the base it is 2.78 MPa [F1]. That gives factors of 5.4 (static) and 4.2 (dynamic) on rigid cast polyurethane, but only 2.0 and 1.6 on the potting under the crown [F2]. The bond is weaker: with a friction coefficient of 0.7 the tire can push 34.3 kN sideways, 1.51 MPa over the 170 mm pad, against an assumed adhesive-to-asphalt strength of 1.0 MPa at 20 °C (factor 0.66) and 0.2 MPa at 50 °C (0.13) [F3]. These are upper bounds, since a truck tire deflects around a 31 mm puck and rarely brakes on it. Wheel geometry helps: a van or car parked inside the bay lines keeps its nearest tire edge at least 462 mm (van) or 275 mm (car) from the puck axis, against a 75 mm puck radius, so parked wheels straddle the puck and only maneuvering wheels cross it [F4]. **R6 is at risk** on debonding under braking; crushing is met on paper. Options are in LDZ-DDR-001, O3.

■ 8. Size and mass (R7)

The model gives a puck 31.0 mm high on a 150 mm base, a 170 mm pad, a 104 mm crown and a 6 mm crown radius [G1]. **R7 is met**. From the model volumes the puck weighs 451 g without its pad, and the pad 75 g [G2]; the TRL 2 estimate of 0.35 kg is corrected, because the cavity is now fully potted.

■ 9. Sign option (R11, R12)

Power (R12). The class C receiver draws 15.2 mW, or 0.364 Wh a day, and 200 redraws add 0.015 Wh; with 90 % rail efficiency the sign draws 0.424 Wh a day, or 17.7 mW [H1]. That is 15 % of FieldNode's published 115 mW allowance and 18 % of the 100 mW figure FieldNode now proposes [H2]. **R12 is met on paper**. The sign takes about 200 downlinks a day, against The Things Network's limit of 10 [H5], so D7 works only on a private network server such as TwinKit, where the downlinks use 33 s a day, or 0.38 % of the RX2 sub-band allowance [H5] (LDZ-DDR-001, O5). Typical 7.5 in e-paper panels are rated for about 0 to 50 °C in operation, so the sign may not refresh on freezing days; this is a limit to confirm with the panel chosen.

Legibility (R11). Digits 78 mm high on the 97.9 mm panel read at about 28.2 m by day at full contrast, using the MUTCD legibility index of 0.36 m per mm; 69 mm digits would be enough for 25 m [H4]. E-paper contrast is lower than a printed sign's, so the daytime figure is optimistic. The panel is unlit, and a 0.5 W front light for 12 h a night would add 6.0 Wh a day, 2.5 times the 100 mW allowance [H3]. **R11 is not met at night**.

■ 10. Cost (R13)

The two-puck kit costs **\$114.00 against** `budget_usd` **\$120**, a margin of \$6.00; one puck costs \$54.00 [I1]. Under D6 the budget covers the two-puck kit only. The sign option costs \$97.00, and its host FieldNode \$126.00 (priced in the FieldNode BOM), for \$337.00 per bay with the sign [I1]. **R13 is met on paper**, with a thin margin on indicative prices.

■ 11. Requirement status

Table 2. Requirement status from this note. The same rows are in `docs/04-calcs/results.csv`.

ID	Requirement	Value	Target	Status
R4	Reach a gateway from road level	-6.0 dB at 1 km NLOS with a van over at SF9; 353 m range with 10 dB fade margin	1 km in a street canyon	Not met
R11	Sign legible (option)	About 28 m by day at full contrast; unlit at night	25 m by day and night	Not met (night)
R1	Detect slot state	Van 10.0 μ T, high-chassis truck 7.7 μ T, weak-steel truck 3.85 μ T, next lane 0.46 μ T against 3 μ T	97 % correct over a day	At risk (not verifiable at TRL 3)
R5	Fair-use airtime	7.7 s at SF7, 25.5 s at SF9, 51.0 s at SF10, 183.9 s at SF12	30 s a day or less	At risk (not met at SF10 to SF12)
R6	Survive traffic	Crown 7.4 MPa, factor 5.4 on PU and 2.0 on potting; bond shear 1.51 MPa, factor 0.66 at 20 °C	49 kN wheel, no cracking or debonding	At risk (debond under braking)
R14	Quick install	Bonded pad, no road cutting	15 min per puck	Not verifiable at TRL 3
R2	Report quickly	17.7 s typical; 38.6 s worst at SF9, 59.2 s at SF10	60 s or less	Met on paper (SF10 or faster)
R3	Battery life	7.7 years at SF9; 2.8 years at SF12	5 years or more	Met on paper
R7	Low profile	31 mm high, 150 mm diameter, 6 mm crown radius, yellow	35 mm or less, rounded	Met on paper
R12	Sign power (option)	0.42 Wh a day (17.7 mW)	Within the FieldNode allowance	Met on paper (private network only)
R13	Low cost	\$114.00 for two pucks	\$120 or less	Met on paper
R8	Weather and temperature	Parts rated -40 to +85 °C with an 85 °C pulse capacitor; fully potted	IP68; -25 to +70 °C	Met by design (sealing not verifiable at TRL 3)
R9	Privacy	Magnetometer only; state, timer, confidence, voltage, temperature	No images, audio or identifiers	Met by design
R10	Open data	CDS Events <code>park_start</code> , <code>park_end</code> , <code>scheduled_report</code> , <code>comms_lost</code> , <code>comms_restored</code> ; Metrics for occupancy and dwell	Maps onto CDS Events and Metrics	Met by design
R15	Tamper resistance	No external fasteners; removal flagged by a field and orientation step	No screws; removal reported	Met by design

Counts: 2 not met, 3 at risk, 1 not verifiable at TRL 3, 5 met on paper, 4 met by design [K].

The Curb Data Specification event types used for R10 were checked against the specification's Events API on 2026-09-25 ([Open Mobility Foundation, CDS Events](#)).

■ 12. Checks against the TRL 2 figures

Table 3. TRL 2 claims (LDZ-PRC-001 v0.2) against this note.

TRL 2 claim	This note	Action
About 20 s to report	17.7 s typical, 38.6 s worst at SF9	Precis updated
About 1.2 mAh a day, about 7 years	1.11 mAh a day, 7.7 years at SF9	Precis updated
72 ms at SF7, 247 ms at SF9; 9 s and 31 s a day	61.7 ms and 205.8 ms for 12 bytes; 7.7 s and 25.5 s a day	Corrected; R5 now met at SF9
A vehicle overhead leaves room for a gateway a few hundred meters away	353 m with a 10 dB fade margin	Stands; R4 not met at 1 km
2.8 MPa over the base; printed housing would fail	2.78 MPa over the base, 7.38 MPa at the crown; cast PU adopted	Precis updated; bond is the new risk
Sign legible at about 10 m	About 28 m by day at full contrast	Corrected; R11 still not met at night
Sign about 0.4 Wh a day	0.42 Wh a day drawn	Stands
Puck about 0.35 kg	451 g without pad	Corrected
Two-puck kit about \$110	\$114.00 with the diodes and 85 °C capacitor	Corrected